

# Hodge Deligne Numbers for Hypersurfaces in Toric Varieties

Will Gilroy

July 2026

## 1 Mike Meeting 03 Aug

Mike took us through some of the basic ideas. It was a long meeting, but there were a lot of ideas, and so this is a writeup for some of the ideas from that meeting.

Any text in purple indicates either a question from myself or an incomplete thought.

### 1.1 Definition of Hodge-Deligne Numbers and Some Basic Properties

Let  $X$  be a variety over  $\mathbb{C}$  of dimension<sup>1</sup>  $n$ . The *Hodge-Deligne numbers* denoted  $e^{p,q}(X)$  for  $0 \leq p, q \leq n$  are a collection of integers satisfying properties soon to be described. Moreover the polynomial  $e_X(x, y) := \sum_{0 \leq p, q \leq n} e^{p,q}(X) x^p y^q$  is called the *Hodge-Deligne polynomial*. The Hodge-Deligne numbers and polynomial satisfy the following properties

- The Hodge-Deligne polynomial is symmetric in  $x, y$ ,  $e_X(x, y) = e_X(y, x)$ . In other words, the Hodge-Deligne numbers are symmetric in  $p, q$ ,  $e^{p,q}(X) = e^{q,p}$ .
- If  $X$  is reducible then the Hodge-Deligne polynomial decomposes additively over the components: if  $X = Y \amalg Z$  (presumably these have to be closed subsets?) then  $e_X = e_Y + e_Z$ . (A variety is by definition irreducible, so, perhaps the most general setting is for a separated, finite type over  $\mathbb{C}$ -scheme? Or maybe this property is supposed to be for closed subvarieties?)
- If  $X$  is a product variety then its Hodge-Deligne polynomial decomposes multiplicatively: if  $X = Y \times_{\mathbb{C}} Z$  then  $e_X = e_Y e_Z$ .
- If  $X$  is projective and smooth (over  $\mathbb{C}$ ) then recall that the hodge numbers are the dimensions of the  $\mathbb{C}$ -vector spaces given by cohomology over the sheaf of differentials

$$h^{p,q}(X) = \dim_{\mathbb{C}} H^q(X, \Omega_X^p).$$

---

<sup>1</sup>A variety is defined to be separated, irreducible, finite type  $k$ -scheme. I am trying to remember why we have that a variety has a well-defined dimension.

In this setting, the Hodge-Deligne numbers are related to the Hodge numbers in the following way

$$e^{p,q}(X) = (-1)^{p+q} \cdot h^{p,q}(X).$$

## 1.2 Examples

**Example 1** (A point). Let  $X = \{*\} = \text{Spec}(\mathbb{C})$ . We have that  $X$  is smooth and projective. The following Hodge calculation will give that  $e_X(x, y) = 1$ .

Since  $X$  is affine  $H^q(X, \Omega_X^p)$  is non-vanishing only for  $q = 0$ . Recall that  $\Omega_X^p = 0$  for all  $p > 0$  (I have forgotten why this is true, but it follows because  $X$  is a point. I think it should be easy to build the module of differentials in this case once one remembers the definition and construction) and so  $h^{p,q} = 0$  for all  $p, q > 0$ . The only possible non-zero Hodge number we may have is for  $p = q = 0$ . We have the following

$$\begin{aligned} h^{0,0}(X) &:= H^0(X, \Omega_X^0) \\ &= \dim_{\mathbb{C}} H^0(X, \mathcal{O}_X) && \text{By definition} \\ &= \dim_{\mathbb{C}} \Gamma(X, \mathcal{O}_X) && \text{By the cohomology axioms} \\ &= \dim_{\mathbb{C}} \mathbb{C} && X = \text{Spec}(\mathbb{C}) \\ &= 1. \end{aligned}$$

Overall, we have that  $h^{0,0}(X) = 1$  and  $h^{p,q}(X) = 0$  for all other  $p, q$ . The claimed result follows.

**Example 2** (Union of Points). It follows from the previous example and the decomposition property of  $e_X$  that a disjoint union of  $n$  points has Hodge-Deligne polynomial  $e_X(x, y) = n$ .

**Example 3** ( $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ ). Performing a similar Hodge computation to the example of the point one can compute that

$$e_{\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1} = 1 + xy.$$

This might be a worthwhile computation.  $\mathbb{P}^1$  is covered by two affine patches and so we only need to compute for  $p < 2$ . We need to recall how to compute the sheaf of differentials however, but I think it should be nonvanishing only degree 0, 1.

**Example 4** ( $\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ ). We can decompose  $P^1 = \mathbb{A}^1 \amalg \{*\}$  the affine line with a “point at infinity”. “point at infinity.” Since  $\mathbb{A}^1$  is an open subset and  $\{*\}$  is a closed point we have

$$e_{\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^1}(x, y) = e_{\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1} - e_{\{*\}} = xy.$$

I'm a bit confused by this example, because the affine line is affine, and so we should expect it to only

have have cohomology in degree 0. That is to say, I would expect that this should be a polynomial only in  $y$ . The Hodge-Deligne numbers agree with the Hodge numbers only when  $X$  is projective –  $\mathbb{A}^1$  is not projective, so we're gucci.

**Example 5** ( $\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^n$ ). Using the product property of the Hodge-Deligne polynomial we have

$$E_{\mathbb{A}^n} = (xy)^n.$$

From this example, we can read off the hodge numbers without needing to do any Hodge computations.

**Example 6** (Algebraic Torii). We can decompose the affine line  $\mathbb{A}^1 = \mathbb{C}^* \amalg \{*\}$  and so using the decomposition property of the Hodge-Deligne polynomial we have

$$e_{\mathbb{C}^*} = e_{\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^1} + e_{\{*\}} = xy - 1.$$

Then, using the product property we further have that

$$e_{(\mathbb{C}^*)^n} = (e_{\mathbb{C}^*})^n = (xy - 1)^n.$$

**Example 7** ( $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^n$ ). Recall that we can decompose  $\mathbb{P}^n = \mathbb{C}^n \amalg \mathbb{P}^{n-1}$  and then we can find the Hodge-Deligne polynomial of  $\mathbb{P}^n$  inductively. Consider,

$$\begin{aligned} e_{\mathbb{P}^1} &= 1 + xy \\ e_{\mathbb{P}^2} &= e_{\mathbb{C}^2} + e_{\mathbb{P}^1} = (xy)^2 + (1 + xy) \\ e_{\mathbb{P}^3} &= e_{\mathbb{C}^3} + e_{\mathbb{P}^2} = (xy)^3 + (1 + xy + (xy)^2) \\ &\dots \\ e_{\mathbb{P}^n} &= 1 + (xy) + (xy)^2 + \dots + (xy)^n. \end{aligned}$$

## 2 Procedure for Hypersurfaces in Toric Varieties.

we should go back and fill out some of the preamble theory here

Suppose we have a full dimension polytope  $\Delta$ . We can decompose our toric variety

$$P_{\Delta} = \amalg_{\Gamma' \leq \Delta} T_{\Gamma'}$$

where  $T_{\Gamma'} = (\mathbb{C}^*)^{\dim \Gamma'}$ . And so we can compute the Hodge-Deligne polynomial of a toric variety using the decomposition property. Does each subcone really just give a torus in a toric variety? Or

is it somehow sufficient to compute the Hodge-Deligne polynomial on a dense open?

Let  $Z_{\Gamma'} = Z \cap T_{\Gamma'}$ . We have the following formula

$$e^{pq}(\bar{Z}) = e^{pq}(Z) + \sum_{\Gamma' < \Delta} e^{pq}(Z_{\Gamma'}).$$

Note that a consequence of this formula is that for  $p = n$  or  $q = n$ ,  $e^{pq}(\bar{Z})$  is determined by  $e^{pq}(Z)$ . I think this should follow from the dimension property of Hodge-Deligne numbers, and each  $e^{pq}(Z_{\Gamma'})$  has dimension strictly less than  $n$ . Is this reasoning correct?

We also have the following formulae

$$e^{pq}(Z) = e^{p+1, q+1}(T) = \begin{cases} 0 & p \neq q \\ (-1)^{n+p+1} \binom{n}{p+1} & p = q \end{cases}$$

And for  $p + q \geq n$ ,

$$\sum_{q=0}^{n-1} e^{pq}(Z) = (-1)^p \left( (-1)^{n+1} \binom{n}{p+1} - \sum_{k \geq 1} (-1)^k \binom{n+1}{p+k+1} \ell^*(k\Delta) \right). \quad (*)$$

where  $\ell^*$  denotes the number of interior lattice points of the given polytope. Is this last formula actually correct?

I think the algorithm is then as follows: we iteratively compute the Hodge-Deligne numbers starting from the smallest cone, and we only need to use formula (\*) to add the numbers in degree  $n$ , is that correct?